

Philipp Hilbert. *Backlog owner who ships, coaches, and automates the rest.*

Positioning, Product Owner with ten years of cross-functional delivery, bringing sprint discipline, AI-native backlog automation, and a coaching mindset to Wire's secure communications mission.

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Dear Wire Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Product Owner role because it combines the two things I care most about in product work: genuine delivery accountability and a mission that actually matters. Wire protects communication for governments, hospitals, and financial institutions. Every prioritisation call carries weight. That is the kind of backlog I want to own.

My most direct parallel is the role I held at Emil Group, where I inherited a 17-person team in delivery crisis, split it into focused Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and rebuilt client trust through weekly product workshops. I did not just administer the process – I coached the team back to a point where it could self-organise. The posting's language about coaching agile maturity rather than being a process gatekeeper maps exactly to what I did there.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned a government defence platform end-to-end: writing user stories, defining acceptance criteria, coordinating multinational stakeholders across security and compliance boundaries, and shipping autonomous feature sets through a GitOps rollout. I also unblocked an infrastructure-level issue independently that engineers had been unable to resolve for over a year, delivering it in a week. Technical fluency is not something I claim abstractly; it is how I protect a sprint from becoming hostage to dependency delays.

On the AI tooling dimension: I use Claude, Copilot, and n8n-based agentic workflows as daily instruments, not as experiments. I have already built grooming automation, status-summary pipelines, and LLM-assisted acceptance-criteria generators for my own delivery work. The posting asks the Product Owner to automate the mechanical layer of the role so judgment time increases. That is not a future aspiration for me – it is how I already operate.

The Qcrypt AG chapter of my career – where I co-founded a quantum-secure encryption product and served as deputy IT security officer – means I understand intuitively why Wire's security posture shapes every feature trade-off. I do not need to be convinced that "ship with the

bug or fix it first" looks different when the product is used by intelligence agencies than when it is used by a consumer app.

I would welcome a conversation about the scope and the team. I am based in Berlin and available on four weeks' notice.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
